

[GAME NAME] — THREE PRE-BUILT PATHS

Paths are **guidance, not rules**. Each is a complete plan from creation to Level 10; swap any pick for any Talent whose gates you meet. Level 1 is the pre-Talent baseline — your dice, tier, and traits carry you until Level 2. All numbers marked (tunable) in the rules are playtest targets.

THE RECKONING — a Berserker's path

Frontline fury. You want enemies swinging at you, because every attack that comes your way is fuel, and every drop of your own blood is a promise.

Health Tier	Frontline (9 + Vigor max HP)	Starting Dice	Vigor d6 · Resolve d6 · Agility d4 · Focus d4
Traits	Heavy-Handed, Steel-Nerved	Die Increases	L3 Vigor→d8 · L5 Vigor→d10 · L7 Resolve→d8 · L9 Agility→d6
Gear	Heavy cleaver (Vicious) or war-axe & shield · medium armor (or war-paint for Unarmored Bulwark later) · javelins · explorer's pack		

Lv	Talent	Why
2	Primal Fury	Momentum when enemies target you; emergency temp HP.
4	Crimson Tide	Below half HP, every melee attack rolls a bonus Vigor Die.
6	Retributive Strike	2 Momentum: answer a melee hit with an Upgraded attack.
8	Crimson Rampage	Kills chain into free movement and another attack.
10	Relentless	Once per combat, refuse to drop; full Momentum, auto-Explosion.

- Wade in and spend AP on attacks — your Momentum arrives when enemies answer.
- Furious Strike (swap a pick, or grab it in another campaign) and flat spends turn glancing rounds into kills; hold 2 tokens for Retributive Strike.
- Below half HP you get stronger, not weaker. Trust the tide.

THE EQUATION — an Arcanist's path

Magic as engineering. You spend Focus like a budget, weave modifications into every casting, and treat each Explosion as compounding interest.

Health Tier	Adept (5 + Vigor max HP)	Starting Dice	Focus d6 · Agility d6 · Vigor d4 · Resolve d4
Traits	Quick-Witted, Perceptive	Die Increases	L3 Focus→d8 · L5 Focus→d10 · L7 Agility→d8 · L9 Vigor→d6
Gear	Arcane Vestments · a Conduit staff or wand · formulary & scholar's pack		

Lv	Talent	Why
2	School of Evocation	Tier 0 element bolts now; Tiers 2/3 unlock at 5 and 9.
4	Spell Weaving	1 Momentum riders: double range, or Sunder Agility Defense.
6	Aetheric Siphon	Every spell Explosion pays you 1 Momentum.
8	Advanced Weaving	Vicious and knockback Weaves join the toolkit.
10	Master of the Weave	Two Weaves per spell, one of them free each turn.

- Open with cheap Tier 1 spells to bait Explosions; Siphon converts them to Momentum.
- Weave-Sunder a target, then pour your big Tier 2 into the softened defense.
- Keep 2 Focus in reserve for the round that matters — overspending early is how Adepts die.

THE LONG WATCH — a Stalker's path

Patience made lethal. Mark the kill, control the angles, and let the quarry spend its whole life walking into the one moment you prepared.

Health Tier	Skirmisher (7 + Vigor max HP)	Starting Dice	Agility d6 · Focus d6 · Vigor d4 · Resolve d4
Traits	Agile, Streetwise	Die Increases	L3 Agility→d8 · L5 Agility→d10 · L7 Focus→d8 · L9 Vigor→d6
Gear	Hunter's bow & arrows or paired hunting blades (Finesse) · cured hides · stalker's kit (caltrops, tripwire, smoke) · field pack		

Lv	Talent	Why
2	Marked Quarry	Always know where it is; Upgraded attacks against it.
4	Hunter's Instinct	Momentum from exploiting cover, surprise, and conditions.
6	Visceral Quarry	Once a round, a hit on your Quarry is all True Damage.
8	Apex Predator	Your Quarry cannot run, hide, or vanish from you.
10	One With the Wastes	Move at full speed Hidden; kills refill Momentum.

- Mark before you shoot. Two stacked Upgrades on round one is your baseline.
- Fight from Cover — it feeds Hunter's Instinct and starves the enemy's math.
- Save the Visceral declaration for the turn their Defense would blunt you most.